



Dounreay Nuclear – PMO Service Review & Portfolio Management

As PMO Manager at Dounreay Nuclear, I was engaged to assess, stabilise, and enhance the organisation's project management service capability.

Operating within a multi-vendor environment and delivering into a service integrator model, the role demanded rigorous governance, commercial awareness, and strategic leadership across a complex portfolio landscape.

Initial Service Review & Assessment

My first objective was to conduct a comprehensive review of the existing PMO service, evaluating its structure, processes, and alignment with organisational objectives.

This assessment identified key improvement areas in governance, delivery assurance, and vendor coordination.

Key activities:

- Conducted full PMO service assessment and maturity review
- Documented recommendations for service improvement and optimisation
- Defined governance enhancements and delivery frameworks
- Presented findings and improvement roadmap to senior leadership

The outcome was a clear, actionable plan to elevate PMO performance and strengthen delivery predictability.

 Portfolio Management & Delivery

I led the portfolio management and delivery function, ensuring alignment between strategic objectives and operational execution.

This included oversight of multiple concurrent projects across engineering, IT, and infrastructure domains.

Responsibilities:

- Portfolio planning, prioritisation, and resource allocation
- Delivery tracking and performance reporting
- Risk and issue management across workstreams
- Coordination with service integrator and third-party vendors

Through disciplined governance and transparent reporting, the PMO became a trusted source of delivery insight and control.

Financial & Commercial Management

Operating within a multi-vendor environment, I managed the P&L for the PMO service, ensuring cost efficiency and contractual compliance.

Key achievements:

- Established cost-tracking and forecasting mechanisms
- Managed vendor contracts and performance metrics
- Ensured alignment between financial obligations and delivery milestones
- Supported commercial negotiations and service-level adherence

This financial stewardship reinforced accountability and value realisation across the delivery ecosystem.

Leadership & Team Management

As line manager for the PMO team, I focused on capability development, clarity of roles, and continuous improvement.

Focus areas:

- Team leadership and mentoring
- Skills development and performance management
- Resource planning and workload balancing
- Embedding a culture of collaboration and delivery excellence

The result was a cohesive, high-performing PMO team aligned to organisational priorities and stakeholder expectations.

Strategic Impact

The engagement delivered a mature, commercially aware PMO service capable of managing complex portfolios within a regulated nuclear environment.

It strengthened governance, improved delivery confidence, and enhanced collaboration across internal teams and external partners.